The Medicaid Application-Ready Checklist

Dad's records to find, keep and ask about, in case your family ever applies.

Dad is managing fine and nobody is applying for anything. You don't need to know any rules to start on this list: it names the records worth finding, a few worth keeping as you go, and the questions worth writing down for later. Go through it with Dad's say-so and check what you've done. Anything unchecked is something to get to when it suits you both, not a verdict about Dad or about you.

Find

- [ ] Identity and residency papers: the ones that show who Dad is and where he lives, such as his birth certificate. Note where each is kept. [2]
- [ ] Social Security and income records: the letters and statements that show what comes in, and from where. [1]
- [ ] Bank statements for each checking and savings account, and how to get them if they're online only. [1]
- [ ] Investment and retirement-account records, with the company that holds each. [1]
- [ ] Insurance records: each policy, and the company it's with. [1]
- [ ] Property records: the deed to his home, and the papers for any other property. [2]
- [ ] Trust or annuity papers, if Dad has any.

Keep

- [ ] One way of keeping statements as they arrive, on paper or online, and one person who keeps it current.
- [ ] A dated note of each significant financial transaction, such as a sale or a large deposit or withdrawal, with whatever paperwork exists.
- [ ] The paperwork for any gift or transfer, with its date. Record what happened, and change nothing.
- [ ] The name of whoever would handle an application if one were ever needed, the professional your family would call, and the date the file was last updated.

Ask about

- [ ] A question to write down for your Medicaid planner: which Medicaid program would likely apply to someone in Dad's situation, and where are applications submitted in his state?
- [ ] Another: which records should a file like this hold in his state, how far back are statements worth keeping, and which documentation problems can delay an application?
- [ ] And one to work out with your Medicaid planner, not at the kitchen table: what circumstances would indicate it is time to apply?

What this checklist doesn't do

It helps you find, keep and ask. It doesn't say which records Dad's state requires or how far back they need to go, what any record means for Medicaid, or whether or when anyone should apply. Rules vary by state, so those questions go to your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You've seen which of Dad's records to find and keep, and your questions for later are written down. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care.

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WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Items marked 1 follow the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau's list of financial documents to keep organized and available. Items marked 2 follow the National Institute on Aging's checklist. The rest come from the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's own working list for this step.

1. Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, Planning for diminished capacity and illness
2. National Institute on Aging, Getting Your Affairs in Order Checklist: Documents to Prepare for the Future

From the Medicaid Planning Roadmap · Richard Ladson, Certified Medicaid Planner. Draft for review, generated 2026-10-04.